DIRECTORATE
MAHARASHTRA
TOURISM

EMPOWERING MAHARASHTRA'S TOURISM

A VISION FOR GROWTH & INNOVATION

With the ambitious vision of transforming Maharashtra into a USD 1 trillion economy by 2028, the state government has unveiled a pioneering tourism policy aimed at revolutionizing the sector. The comprehensive strategy aspires to create 1.8 million jobs over the next decade while attracting robust investments from key industry players and stakeholders. This forward-thinking policy is set to bolster the state's GDP, driving growth from the current 8 percent to an impressive 14 percent, all while positioning Maharashtra as a global tourist hub.

The newly introduced tourism policy is designed to foster investment opportunities, generate employment, and enhance infrastructure to elevate Maharashtra's tourism offerings. The government has earmarked a budget of INR 12 crore to support the policy's initiatives and its promotion through incentives and schemes that cater to a wide array of tourism sectors.

The policy encompasses several niche tourism areas such as agritourism, adventure tourism, and the increasingly popular caravan tourism. By focusing on these areas, the state aims to reinvigorate its tourism landscape, fostering collaborations with stakeholders including tour operators and organizers of Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE).

Cruise Tourism

Recognizing Maharashtra's vast coastline as an underutilized asset, the government has taken significant steps to unlock its tourism potential. Among the key initiatives are the construction of various tourism jetties at strategic locations, including Padmadurg in Raigad, Suvarnadurg in Ratnagiri, and Kashid in Raigad, among others. These jetties will not only facilitate easier access to Maharashtra's coastal treasures but will also encourage maritime tourism.

In addition to coastal tourism, river tourism is also a pivotal focus. The state has integrated itself into the prestigious Luxury River Cruise Tourism project between Gujarat and Madhya Pradesh, opening up the Sardar Sarovar portion of Maharashtra from Nandurbar to the iconic Statue of Unity. Furthermore, rivers like Vashishti in Konkan and perennial rivers like Godavari and Narmada will be developed for budget river and local ferry cruises, ensuring a diverse and enriching experience for travelers. Moreover, the state aims to develop major and medium dams in regions like Konkan, Nashik, Pune, and Nagpur as significant tourist attractions. This will be achieved through the incorporation of houseboats, budget river cruises, and eco-friendly tourism activities that align with Maharashtra's vision for sustainable tourism.

MICE Bureau to Promote Events

The government plans to further elevate the events industry by establishing a Tourism MICE Bureau. This bureau will focus on promoting high-profile events and conferences in Maharashtra, encouraging the state's growth as a preferred destination for both national and international events. This initiative is expected to generate substantial employment opportunities while solidifying Maharashtra's reputation as a premier location for marquee events.

Involving Youth in Tourism Growth

The government has acknowledged the crucial role that youth can play in shaping Maharashtra's tourism future. Through the YUVA Tourism initiative, youth clubs across schools, colleges, and other educational institutions will be provided with a grant of INR 25,000 to organize tourism-related activities. This initiative seeks to empower the younger generation, ensuring they actively contribute to Maharashtra's evolving tourism landscape.

Tourism Mitra: Ensuring Safety and Sustainability

The government has introduced "Tourism Mitra," a dedicated task force aimed at ensuring safe and responsible tourism across the state. This initiative will deploy personnel at key tourist destinations to safeguard the well-being of visitors, particularly women. In addition, the task force will actively work to preserve the cleanliness of tourist sites by enforcing regulations against non-biodegradable waste, ensuring these locations remain pristine and sustainable.

Sustainability at the Core

A strong emphasis on sustainability underpins the entire tourism policy, with numerous incentives provided to encourage eco-friendly practices. Tourism units are encouraged to adopt measures like rainwater harvesting, installation of renewable energy systems (including solar panels and wind turbines), and the use of electric vehicles within tourist facilities.

Further, waste management solutions, including sewage treatment plants and organic waste converters, will be incentivized, ensuring that tourism projects contribute to environmental preservation. The use of smart technologies such as IoT and cloud solutions for water management and waste treatment will also be promoted, reinforcing Maharashtra's commitment to sustainable development.



The government's commitment to promoting sustainable tourism practices, emphasizing the need to preserve Maharashtra's rich cultural heritage and natural beauty while simultaneously catering to the rising influx of domestic and international tourists. The policy is designed to incentivize investments in tourism infrastructure, including the development of eco-friendly resorts, adventure tourism initiatives, and improved connectivity to popular destinations, such as the Western Ghats, historical forts, and coastal attractions. Furthermore, the new policy also aims to leverage digital technology for enhancing visitor services, streamlining booking processes, and providing real-time information to travelers. By prioritizing safety, cleanliness, and visitor satisfaction, Maharashtra aspires to position itself as a leading tourist destination in India, inviting travelers to explore not only its famous landmarks but also its hidden gems, thus paving the way for a vibrant and inclusive tourism sector that contributes to the state's sustainable growth. Overall, the new tourism policy is envisioned as a blueprint for holistic growth in the sector, creating jobs, supporting local economies, and positioning Maharashtra as a leading player in India's tourism industry for years to come.

GIRISH MAHAJAN,
Minister of Tourism, Government of Maharashtra

Investor Facilitation and Single-Window Clearance

To ensure seamless investment in the sector, the govern-